

Honey Peaches and Cream Pudding

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Ready In 50 min, plus 2 hr
chilling

Rating ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ (42)

Following the structure of a classic banana pudding, this honeyed peach pudding is here to make the most out of the peach season and celebrate the orange-fleshed juicy fruit. With layers of honey-sweetened peaches, silky vanilla pudding, freshly whipped cream, and crisp vanilla wafers to soak up the spiced peach juices, it's easy to see how this dessert tastes like summer on a plate. Great for working through those overripe peaches on your counter in the middle of summer, this recipe uses three pounds of them, ensuring each scoop has a tender peach to bite into. While the recipe doesn't call for it, peeling the peaches yields a silkier texture if you have a chance to tackle that process.

INGREDIENTS

Yield: 12 to 16 servings

FOR THE PEACHES

3 pounds ripe peaches (10 to 12 medium peaches)

¼ cup honey

2 tablespoons lemon juice

2 teaspoons vanilla extract

1 tablespoon orange blossom water, optional

1 teaspoon ground cardamom

½ teaspoon kosher salt, such as Diamond Crystal

FOR THE PUDDING

2 cups whole milk

1 (3.4-ounce) packet instant vanilla pudding mix (or make your own; see Tip)

PREPARATION

Step 1

Prepare the peaches: Set aside 2 whole peaches and 12 vanilla wafers for the topping. Cut the remaining peaches into bite-sized chunks. In a medium bowl, toss together the peaches, honey, lemon juice, vanilla, orange blossom water (if using), cardamom and salt and set aside to macerate.

Step 2

Make the pudding: In a medium bowl, whisk together the milk, instant pudding mix, honey, vanilla and salt. Set aside in the fridge for 5 minutes. In a large bowl, using a hand mixer or a stand mixer with the whisk attachment, whip the heavy cream to stiff peaks. Add the pudding to the whipped cream and gently fold until combined. (The peaches and the pudding can be prepped up to 2 days ahead; store them separately in the refrigerator until ready to assemble.)

Step 3

In a 9-by-13-inch casserole dish, spread half of the pudding, then top with half of the vanilla wafers in an even layer. Drizzle about 3

2 tablespoons honey
2 teaspoons vanilla extract
½ teaspoon kosher salt, such as
Diamond Crystal
1 ½ cups heavy cream
1 (11-ounce) package vanilla wafer
cookies

FOR THE TOPPING

2 cups heavy cream
¼ cup honey, plus more for topping
1 ½ teaspoons ground cardamom
¼ teaspoon kosher salt, such as
Diamond Crystal

tablespoons of the liquid from the macerated peaches over the wafers (save any remaining peach syrup to use in fizzy iced drinks). Using a slotted spoon, scoop half of the peaches and layer on top of the wafers. Repeat one more time, using the remaining pudding, wafers and sliced peaches.

Step 4

Cover and chill the assembled pudding in the fridge for at least 3 hours (or up to 1 day.)

Step 5

Before serving (or up to 2 days in advance), make the topping: In a medium bowl, whip the heavy cream to stiff peaks. Add the honey, cardamom and salt and gently stir to combine.

Step 6

When ready to serve, dollop the whipped cream on the pudding, swirling it around with the back of a spoon until it reaches the sides of the bowl. Garnish with the reserved vanilla wafers, then cut the reserved peaches into small wedges and arrange on top. Finish with a drizzle of honey.

TIP

If you'd like to make the vanilla pudding from scratch, follow [this recipe](#) from Mark Bittman, stirring in 2 tablespoons honey at the end of cooking. Refrigerate until room temperature, then fold in the whipped cream as instructed in Step 2 and proceed with the recipe.

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